

Curriculum Vitae

David Zaddach

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PROFILE

Senior Director / Head of Product (Technology) | Music publishing, royalties & rights technology

Target role: VP Product, Head of Technology or CPO at music companies, publishers, labels & rights organisations

Product and technology leader across music publishing, copyright and royalties — from hands-on music content operations to portfolio leadership at BMG. Deep domain knowledge in licensing, metadata, royalty platforms and B2B music tech; focused on modernising rights infrastructure and measurable outcomes for labels and publishers.

SKILLS & KNOWLEDGE

- Music publishing, licensing & copyright operations
- Royalties, sync & rights platform modernisation
- B2B platform scaling in music & media
- Executive product & technology leadership
- Portfolio strategy, prioritisation & multi-year roadmaps
- P&L ownership, budgeting & vendor governance
- Stakeholder management across labels, societies & partners
- AI strategy for music catalogue, metadata & operations

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BMG, The New Music Company, Berlin

Senior Director Technology Products, Head of Product

July 2023 to present

- Own portfolio of 50+ technology products across royalties, copyright, sync and publishing workflows and ~€40M IT budget; investment, roadmap and outcomes aligned with music business priorities
- Lead 15 product owners (internal and external), 10 vendor partners and 150+ developers; align business units and engineering to deliver at scale
- Led decommissioning of legacy monolithic copyright and royalties platform (iMaestro); delivered sync pitching tool, microservices and APIs to modernise

music publishing and royalty operations

- Full-cycle budget and vendor governance: selection, performance, risk, planning, prioritisation, approvals, forecasting and in-year control

Director Business Services

Jan. 2023 to July 2023

- Drove evolution of business services products and operating processes; improved service delivery and operational readiness across the unit
- Aligned operations, product and business stakeholders on priorities and roadmap; reduced handoff friction and kept cross-functional delivery on track

Senior Product Owner Business Services

May 2022 to Dec. 2022

- Owned business services backlog and priorities; translated requirements into a focused roadmap aligned with business outcomes
- Partnered with engineering and business teams to clarify scope, unblock delivery and maintain predictable release cadence

ICE (International Copyright Enterprise) / ICE Services GmbH, Germany

Senior Product Owner

May 2020 to April 2022

- Owned outcomes for all online processing systems and two Scrum teams; delivered roadmap priorities for ICE's licensing back office serving collecting societies and publishers
- Aligned business, IT, customer and shareholder stakeholders on backlog and releases; kept cross-functional delivery predictable at platform scale
- Drove online operations coordination including dispute management; improved reliability and throughput of high-volume copyright and licensing workflows
- Translated operational and regulatory requirements into backlog priorities; sustained continuous delivery across the online processing portfolio

Earlier roles: product management and business analysis

2015 to 2020

- Progressed from senior product manager and business analyst to product owner for ICE's online copyright and licensing platform.
- Owned requirements, specifications and backlog prioritisation for online processing systems and platform development.
- Partnered with engineering on continuous delivery and aligned releases with business and operational goals.

freenet digital GmbH (Jesta Digital & Fox Mobile Distribution), Berlin

Earlier career: product, content operations and team leadership

2008 to 2015

- Progressed from team lead for audio production and content ingestion to product manager for mobile products and content services.
- Built music content operations, CMS workflows and label partner onboarding; introduced Scrum and scaled full-track music as a core mobile content

category.

- Owned roadmaps, KPI tracking and launch delivery across content ingestion, licensing, metadata and mobile product releases.

MUSIC INDUSTRY & CREATIVE BACKGROUND

Music production & independent label

2000 to present

- Active music producer and label entrepreneur; ongoing projects with artists such as [Knaller Soundsystem](#) and [David Main](#).
- Co-founded and managed independent label 24-7 Records (2003 to 2005).

Internships and early industry roles

1999 to 2008

- [Universal Music](#), Berlin — internship in product coordination / operations (2007 to 2008).
- Project work in marketing & PR at [Akademie der Künste](#), Studio for Electroacoustic Music, Berlin (2006).
- Sound recording / engineering for short film "Wasser & Papayas" (2006).
- Project work in marketing & PR at [Rianoni Music](#), Berlin (2005).
- [Moneypenny](#), Paris — music production internship (2002).
- [DResearch Digital Media Systems GmbH](#) — assistant on projects and administration (1999 to 2001).

EDUCATION

Magister Artium , Technische Universität Berlin

Graduated 2007

- Overall grade: very good.
- Master thesis (German title): Die Nutzung der Zensur aus künstlerischen und ökonomischen Interessen in der Populärmusik (grade: very good).
- Major: musicology (2002 to 2007).
- Minors: economics, communication science.

CERTIFICATIONS (SELECTION)

- Bertelsmann IT Circle (3 years project for IT experts within Bertelsmann)
- ITIL (Information Technology Infrastructure Library) certification

LANGUAGES

- German: native
- English: fluent

Berlin, 12 May 2026